

Warhammer 40000 : Dawn of War

Dawn of War (DoW), the latest in the Warhammer 40,000 series, brings splendid graphics to the franchise, with realistic and brutal combat. Multiplayer is where DoW excels - the action is hot, yet key elements of the RTS (Real Time Strategy) genre haven't been forgotten.

Whether you're a newbie or a DoW fanatic, these tips should prove invaluable.

He Who Scouts Early Wins

Build at least two as the game starts. You need to capture as many requisition points as early as possible. This gives you an early resource lead. Additionally, wresting resource points later in the game from the enemy is never easy.

Race For Those Wheels

Try to build vehicles as early as possible. Your enemy will most probably not have an infantry response to vehicles early in the game. Avoid wasting resources on research very early on.

Offend... Don't Defend

Do not build turrets around captured points. An exercise in futility because even a commander unit with a single squad will easily destroy them.

It's All About The Leader

Commanders units are formidable opponents early in the game, and use devastating melee, so make sure your Commander is at the forefront. Later on in the game Commanders fall prey to powerful squads and vehicles so make sure to keep him attached to a fully upgraded squad.

Space Marines

Perhaps the most balanced of the DoW races, with strong tier one, an unstoppable tier three units, and some of the best vehicles in the game.

Marine Tactics

Harass enemies early. Use scouts with sniper upgrades and stealth to get close to the enemy base and clonk a few enemy units. When you withdraw, keep space marine squads and your commander on either side of the route of retreat. Enemies following will surely get fried in the ensuing crossfire.

Get That Bazooka...

Upgrade your space marines with rockets. Anti-infantry upgrades aren't necessary, because dreadnoughts can easily take out multiple squads.

Maximum Loadout = Maximum Hammering

When using the orbital relay to teleport terminators, make sure to first teleport them near your base, and fully upgrade the squad and their weapons. Never send weak squads into battle.

Command Me!

A commander attached to an Assault Terminator squad makes more sense than him being attached to any other squad. This combination can even take out vehicles and buildings. Assault Terminators are the strongest of the melee grunts available.

Space Marines

The Orks are the most "fun to play" race in the DoW universe. They aren't very tough, and victory while playing as Ork should be attempted while in Tier 1, because they aren't that tough later on.

If DoW = Earth, Ork = China

Orks are all about numbers, that title just says it all doesn't it? Slugga's are the most powerful of the initial infantry among all the civilizations, and will easily defeat scouts, guardians and cultists.

No Retreat, No Surrender

Don't forget to push forward, when you play as Ork, don't dawdle - fight and advance as much as you can, because their later units aren't that powerful.

Rokkit Launcha time

Ork vehicles aren't that powerful - the faster ones are low on firepower, and the powerful units are too slow. Upgrade your tank busta squad with anti-vehicle rockets ASAP.

Eldar

The Eldar or 'foul Xenos' as other races refer to them, are the most mobile of strike forces in the DoW universe. Good variety in ground troops, but unfortunately their melee is pathetic. You need to play carefully as Eldar, and use a lot of micro. Fire Prisms are good, and very mobile, you'll be using a lot of them.

Fleet-Foot

Eldar are fast - just as well, because their infantry melee sucks. Use Dark Reapers/ Wrap Spiders in cover positions if you want to snipe or prepare for hit and runs. You could use two groups, one to hit and the other to cover whilst retreating.

She's The One

The Farseer has the most special abilities amongst all the commander units, however she is weaker than other commanders as well, and will fall in melee combat, and even to some ranged



Fire Prisms "Jump" in action



Lightsaber? Naw that's a lascannon in action

units. Keep her attached to a squad, even early in the game.

Skip bombing tactics...

Use the Fire Prism's jump capability to jump near enemy buildings (target ones with defense capabilities or strategic ones first), and quickly jump back to avoid taking retaliation fire.

Use Those Lasers

Make sure to upgrade your Wraithlords with anti-vehicle weaponry and not anti-infantry, as they are already effective against infantry squads.

Chaos

The forces of Chaos have good commanders, and even more infantry versatility than the almighty Space Marines. Unfortunately their vehicles sorely lack depth.

Possessed And Lovin It

The forces of Chaos have a very underutilized unit called Possessed Space Marines. This unit is excellent at destroying enemy morale and entire squads in a jiffy. They also pose a serious challenge to non-melee vehicles in close combat. The best part is they are Tier 2, so they can be built long before Terminator squads. Attach a Chaos Commander for that added punch!

Sneaky Pests...

Chaos Space Marines can also use invisibility (much like) Marine Scout squads. Only they pack a greater wallop. Upgrade them and use for hit and run attacks. Only don't forget to run! ■